

**Question:**

A 47-year-old woman presents for a routine wellness checkup. She complains of general fatigue and lethargy for the past 6 months. She does not have a significant past medical history and is currently not taking any medications. The patient reports that she drinks “socially” approx. 6 nights a week. She says she also enjoys a “nightcap,” which is 1-2 glasses of wine before bed every night. She denies any history of drug use or smoking. The patient is afebrile, and her vital signs are within normal limits. A physical examination reveals pallor of the mucous membranes. Her laboratory findings are significant for a mean corpuscular volume of 72 fL, leukocyte count of 5,300/mL, hemoglobin of 11.0 g/dL, and platelet count of 420,000/mL. Which of the following is the most likely cause of this patient’s thrombocytosis? Answer Choices: A. Iron deficiency anemia B. Chronic alcohol abuse C. Chronic myelogenous leukemia (CML) D. Aplastic anemia

**Reasoning + Answer:**

<think>The assistant is thinking about the fact that the patient has been experiencing general fatigue and lethargy for the past 6 months, and that she has a history of drinking "socially" approx. 6 nights a week, as well as enjoying a "nightcap" of 1 - 2 glasses of wine before bed every night. The physical examination reveals pallor of the mucous membranes, and the laboratory findings are significant for a mean corpuscular volume of 72 fL, leukocyte count of 5,300/mL, hemoglobin of 11.0 g/dL, and platelet count of 420,000/mL. The assistant is considering the fact that chronic alcohol abuse can cause a variety of symptoms, including thrombocytosis, which is an increase in the number of platelets in the blood. This can be caused by a variety of factors, including the fact that alcohol can cause the bone marrow to produce more platelets, as well as the fact that alcohol can cause a variety of other symptoms that can lead to an increase in platelet production. </think> <answer> B . Chronic alcohol abuse </answer>

